

Vivaldi arrived, Charles died unexpectedly and the composer's career petered out. He died in Vienna the following year and was given a very modest funeral, which suggests that he was short of money. Although he had earned a considerable amount throughout his career, he also spent profusely, not least on producing his operas.

“ Such playing has **not been heard** before
and can **never be equaled** ... ”

J.F.A. VON UFFENBACH, ON HEARING VIVALDI
PLAYING A SOLO, 1715

After his death, Vivaldi's reputation declined and he remained virtually forgotten throughout the 19th century. Scholarly interest in the composer emerged in the early 20th century and in 1926 was given a boost by the discovery of a large collection of his scores, including hundreds of previously unknown works.

However, Vivaldi's popular fame did not develop significantly until the 1950s, closely linked with the rise of LP records, which first appeared in 1948. The Four Seasons seemed tailor-made for the new format (with two concertos fitting neatly on each side) and the work soon caught the public imagination.